Static CDN Cache Test

A short reference for the GitHub Pages origin and Alibaba Cloud CDN lab.

What the components do

GitHub Pages hosts the static site as the origin. **Alibaba Cloud CDN** provides an edge network in front of that origin and can cache eligible responses closer to visitors.

Cache behavior

A cache hit serves an eligible object from an edge cache. A cache miss means the edge does not have a usable copy and must retrieve it from the origin. A browser cache is stored on the visitor's device; an edge cache is stored by the CDN. They are separate layers.

Resource	Suggested TTL	Reason
/api/news.json	1 minute or no cache	Frequently updated data
/index.html	10 minutes	Show page updates soon
Images	7 days	Usually change infrequently
CSS and JavaScript	1 day	Static, but may be updated
PDF files	3 days	Infrequent download changes

Updating cached content

When the origin changes, an edge can keep serving its existing copy until its time to live expires or the object is revalidated. A purge or refresh asks the CDN to remove or refresh specified cached URLs. A preload is different: it asks the CDN to fetch selected content into cache ahead of demand.

Use a small number of manual requests for the lab. Compare the origin and accelerated host, inspect response headers and monitoring, and describe only what the collected evidence supports.

> **This reference contains no student identity or account credentials.**